

— EDITION 39

From a vague ask to a deployed system, on one real constraint

The brief was basically one line, with a hard constraint baked in. That constraint did most of the architecting for me.

A 7-part breakdown

SWIPE >>>>

0101 / 07

| The one-line brief.

Underspecified, with a single non-negotiable limit attached. Most people see that as a problem. I see the limit as the first design decision, already made for me.

0202 / 07

| The constraint.

A hard ceiling on cost and moving parts. No budget for servers that sit idle, no appetite for infrastructure to babysit. Everything after this had to respect it.

0303 / 07

| What the limit ruled out.

A live server running around the clock. A database to host and secure. A stack of services to monitor. All gone, because the constraint would not pay for them.

0404 / 07

| What the limit ruled in.

A site built once at deploy time, not assembled on every request. The schema lives in the build step, not a database. The cheapest service to run is the one that does not exist.

0505 / 07

The decision that followed.

Generate everything ahead of time, serve static files, let a free host carry them. There is no runtime to fail at 2am, because there is barely a runtime at all.

0606 / 07

| The result.

A running system that costs almost nothing to operate and has almost nothing that can break, because most of the moving parts were designed out, not added in.

0707 / 07

| The lesson.

The limit was the architecture. A hard constraint is a design tool, not an obstacle. It handed me a simpler, more durable build than money would have.

— THE TAKEAWAY

The constraint was the **design.**

Which of your best technical calls were forced rather than chosen? Follow Joseph Bankole for more, from loose intent to running system.

◆ Joseph Bankole